Overlock Machine



Category: **Sewing, Textile & Handicraft** Type: **Full SOP** Priority: **High** 2 labs

Covers these lab items: Over lock Machine (5 thread over lock machine); Over-lock machine

What it is used for

An overlock sewing machine stitches fabric edges, trims excess fabric, and forms an overedge seam using multiple threads. Use the correct needle, thread arrangement, and settings for the fabric and required seam.

Main parts

- Needle assembly and presser foot
- Upper and lower loopers
- Thread guides and tension controls
- Fabric feed dogs and differential feed control
- Cutting knife and knife guard
- Motor, foot pedal, and power switch

Before you start

1. Confirm the machine is suitable for the fabric and seam type.
2. Inspect the needle, presser foot, loopers, knife, guards, and power cord.
3. Ensure the machine is switched off before threading or changing the needle.
4. Thread the machine according to the threading diagram and required thread count.
5. Check needle size, thread type, tension, and stitch settings for the fabric.
6. Clear the worktable and keep fingers away from the cutting knife.

How to use

1. Place the fabric under the presser foot with the edge aligned to the cutting guide.
2. Lower the presser foot to hold the fabric securely.
3. Switch on the machine and test the stitch on a fabric scrap.
4. Adjust stitch length, differential feed, and thread tension if required.
5. Guide the fabric steadily without pulling or pushing it forcefully.
6. Keep hands clear of the needle, loopers, and cutting knife while sewing.
7. Observe stitch formation, edge trimming, and fabric feeding during operation.
8. Stop the machine before correcting thread tangles or adjusting the fabric near the needle.
9. At the end of the seam, allow a short thread chain to form if required.
10. Raise the presser foot and remove the fabric carefully after the machine stops.
11. Switch off and disconnect power before cleaning or changing machine parts.
12. Remove lint and thread waste and store the machine safely.

⚠ Safety

- Only trained users should operate the overlock machine.
- Never place fingers near the moving needle, loopers, or cutting knife.
- Switch off and disconnect power before threading, needle changes, or maintenance.
- Keep guards fitted and do not operate with damaged safety covers.
- Tie back long hair and secure loose clothing away from moving parts.
- Use the correct needle and replace bent or damaged needles immediately.

Care & storage

- Remove lint and thread waste from the feed area after use.
- Clean and lubricate specified points according to the manufacturer's instructions.
- Inspect the knife, needle, loopers, and thread guides regularly.
- Arrange servicing if the machine skips stitches, vibrates excessively, or makes unusual noise.

Common mistakes to avoid

- Threading the machine in the wrong sequence.
- Using incorrect thread tension or needle size for the fabric.
- Pulling the fabric forcefully and causing uneven seams.
- Cleaning or adjusting the machine while it is running.

Disclaimer: This SOP is prepared from general information available on the internet. For detailed instructions, refer to the manufacturer's original manual / file.

Prepared by - Subodh Kumar